

Moving on

Every year, herds of zebras join wildebeests to travel a clockwise circuit around the Serengeti, following the rains. By winter, they have returned south and are ready to give birth again.

Zebra foals

Most foals are born in January and February. The foals can stand soon after they're born, and they feed on their mother's milk for up to a year. The young are vulnerable to attack—predators kill about 50 percent of all zebra foals.

Oxpeckers like to hitch rides on the backs of zebras.

Cheetahs hide in the long grass and prey on zebra foals.

Oxpeckers These birds feed on parasites, including bloodsucking ticks, fleas, and biting flies, found on the skin of zebras. The bird's alarm call warns the zebra when a predator approaches.



Wildebeests Zebras and wildebeests are often found living in mixed herds, and both follow the Serengeti migration—though a wildebeest's pregnancy is shorter than a zebra's.



Giraffes Giraffes are also found in the Serengeti. However, because giraffes cannot swim or cross rivers, they do not follow the migration. They survive the dry season by nibbling on the branches of tall acacia trees.



See also

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